ARN Professional Lobbies
ATC Handbook

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This handbook will serve as a guideline for all current and future Air Traffic Controllers on the ARN ATCteam. This handbook should be studied and used as a reference to ensure consistency and fairness in the ARN Vtol Vr Lobbies. This handbook will outline expectations, procedures, and best practices for all Air Traffic Controllers. You are expected to follow this guide when making decisions and interacting with the community.

Signed:

TheRavenSeb

VTOL VR ATC Handbook

Aviation Realism Network

1. Introduction

AirTraffic Control(ATC) in VTOL VR sessions is responsible for maintaining safe and organized airfield operations. Controllers coordinate aircraft movements on the ground, in the airspace, and within the traffic pattern. Without ATC, multiplayer sessions can quickly become chaotic.

Controller Expectations

Professionalism:Treatallpilotsfairly, keep communication clear, and maintain control of the session during busy operations.

Knowledge: Understand taxiways, runway layouts, airspace boundaries, and proper radio phraseology.

2. Taxi Operations

Taxiwaysconnectparkingramps or spawn areas to runways. Controllers guide aircraft safely using taxi instructions.

Example Taxi Instruction

Alpha1-3,taxi toand holdshort of runway 36 via India, Echo.

Holding short means the aircraft must stop before entering the runway until clearance is given.

3. Runways and Wind

Aircraft preferto takeoffandlandinto the wind. Headwinds reduce ground speed and allow aircraft to use less runway distance.

Controllers should choose the runway most aligned with the current wind direction.

4. Traffic Pattern Operations

Thetrafficpatternallowscontrollerstoorganize aircraft arriving and departing visually.

Pattern Leg	Description
Departure / Upwind	Aircraft climbs after takeoff
Crosswind	Aircraft turns left or right as instructed
Downwind	Aircraft flies parallel to the runway

Base	Aircraft turns toward runway and descends
Final	Aircraft lines up with the runway to land

Common ATC Instructions

Cleared to land runway 36.

Cleared for the option runway 36.

Extend downwind for spacing.

Make right 360 for spacing.

5. Weather Information

In VTOL VR sessions the most important weather factors are wind direction and cloud layers.

Session METAR reports are provided through the Aviation Realism Network ATC website.

METAR feed: https://atc-vtolvr.site/atc/metars

Example METAR:

KJBA 011455Z 36005G10KT 10SM SCT050 10/4 A2992

Element	Meaning
KJBA	Airport Identifier
011455Z	Date and Time
36005G10KT	Wind direction and speed
10SM	Visibility
SCT050	Scattered clouds at 5000 ft
10/4	Temperature / dewpoint
A2992	Altimeter setting

6. Controller Roles

Ground Control: Handles taxi operations and ground movement.

Tower: Controls aircraft taking off, landing, and operating within airport airspace.

Approach / Center: Manages aircraft outside the airfield airspace.

7. Airspace

Typical VTOL VR sessions operate within a Class Delta style airspace extending approximately 4 nautical miles from the airport center and up to 2500 feet AGL.

Pilots must establish two-way communication with ATC before entering this airspace.

8. Interceptors and Enforcement

Some sessions include interceptor aircraft that assist controllers in enforcing session rules and escorting non-compliant pilots.

Status	Meaning
Green Flight	Normal operations
Yellow Flight	Busy operations, minimize disruptions
Red Flight	Emergency operations

9. Basic Radio Phraseology

Alpha 1-1 taxi to runway 36 via Echo, hold short.

Alpha 1-1 cleared for takeoff runway 36.

Bravo 2-1 cleared to land runway 36.

Bravo 2-1 enter left downwind runway 36.

10. Final Notes

ATC in VTOL VR should maintain safe aircraft spacing, clear communications, and organized traffic flow. Controllers represent the session and help create an enjoyable and realistic experience for all pilots.